

Ticket 2: Windows Updates and Company Applications Not Working

User Report:

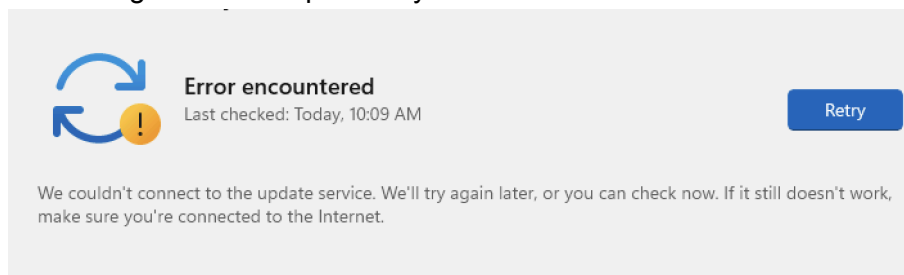
The computer shows that updates are available, but they won't download or install. I can browse some websites, but Outlook and a few company applications cannot connect.

Impact:

- Cannot download or install Windows updates
- Missing security patches and feature updates
- Cannot access some business applications
- Reduced productivity and potential security risk

Resolution:

1. Confirming the issue reported by the user.



Analysis: Attempted to check for and install Windows updates. The update process failed and displayed an error message, but no error code was provided. The computer is already verified to have internet access.

2. Checked the status of Windows Update-related services.

```
PS C:\Users\T900\Documents> Get-Service wuauserv
```

Status	Name	DisplayName
Running	wuauserv	Windows Update

Analysis: Checked Windows Update service (wuauserv) using PowerShell. The service was found to be running.

3. Checking the status of the Background Intelligent Transfer Service (BITS).

```
[PS C:\Users\T900\Documents> Get-Service bits
```

Status	Name	DisplayName
Stopped	bits	Background Intelligent Transfer Ser...

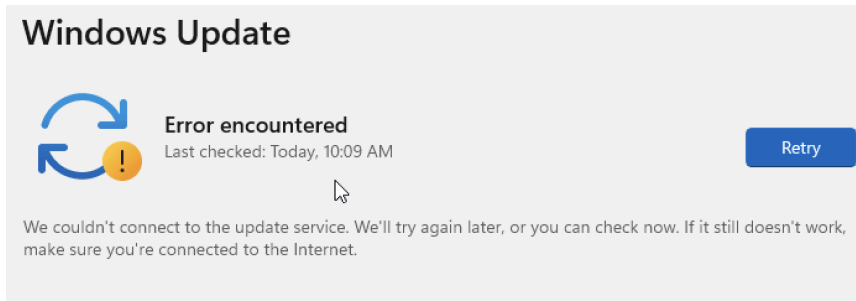
Analysis: The service was found to be stopped. Since Windows Update relies on BITS to download update files in the background, this is identified as a likely cause of the update failures.

4. Starting BITS and verifying that it is running.

```
[PS C:\Users\T900\Documents> Start-Service bits
WARNING: Waiting for service 'Background Intelligent Transfer Service (bits)' to start...
WARNING: Waiting for service 'Background Intelligent Transfer Service (bits)' to start...
[PS C:\Users\T900\Documents> Get-Service bits
```

Status	Name	DisplayName
Running	bits	Background Intelligent Transfer Ser...

5. Retesting Windows Update.



Analysis: Windows Update still fails.

6. Rechecking the status of the BITS.

```
[PS C:\Users\T900\Documents> Get-Service bits
```

Status	Name	DisplayName
Stopped	bits	Background Intelligent Transfer Ser...

Analysis: Verified that BITS service is not running. Windows Update failure persisted after resolving BITS service state. Escalating to system-level repair to address potential component store corruption affecting update functionality.

7. Starting get-service bits and verifying that it is running once more.

```
[PS C:\Users\T900\Documents> Start-Service bits
WARNING: Waiting for service 'Background Intelligent Transfer Service (bits)' to start...
WARNING: Waiting for service 'Background Intelligent Transfer Service (bits)' to start...
[PS C:\Users\T900\Documents> Get-Service bits
```

Status	Name	DisplayName
Running	bits	Background Intelligent Transfer Ser...

Analysis: BITS is running.

8. Now running DISM /Online /Cleanup-Image /RestoreHealth to repair the Windows component store after Windows Update continued to fail despite verified services (BITS, Windows Update).

```
PS C:\Users\T900\Documents> DISM /Online /Cleanup-Image /RestoreHealth

Deployment Image Servicing and Management tool
Version: 10.0.26100.5074

Image Version: 10.0.26200.8457

[=====100.0%=====]
Error: 0x800f0915

The repair content could not be found anywhere.
Check the internet connectivity or use the "Source" option to specify the location of
the files that are required to restore the image. For more information on specifying a
source location, see https://go.microsoft.com/fwlink/?LinkId=243077.

The DISM log file can be found at C:\WINDOWS\Logs\DISM\dism.log
```

9. Running sfc /scannow after DISM to verify and repair protected system files potentially affecting Windows Update functionality.

```
PS C:\Users\T900\Documents> sfc /scannow

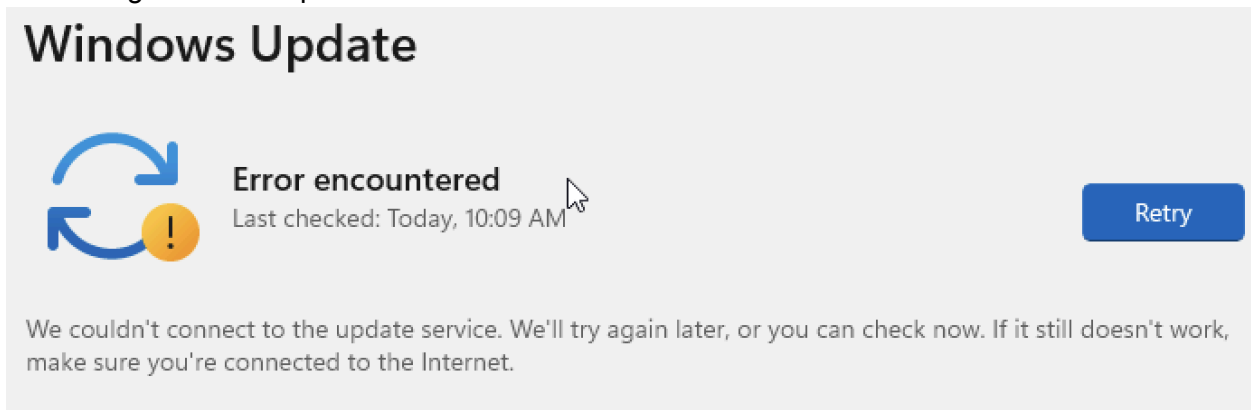
Beginning system scan. This process will take some time.

Beginning verification phase of system scan.
Verification 100% complete.

Windows Resource Protection found corrupt files and successfully repaired them.
For online repairs, details are included in the CBS log file located at
windir\Logs\CBS\CBS.log. For example C:\Windows\Logs\CBS\CBS.log. For offline
repairs, details are included in the log file provided by the /OFFLOGFILE flag.
PS C:\Users\T900\Documents>
```

Analysis: SFC scan completed and detected corrupted system files. Windows Resource Protection successfully repaired the corruption using the repaired component store from DISM. This indicates system file integrity issues were present and may have impacted Windows Update functionality.

10. Testing Windows Update



Analysis: Windows Update still fails.

10. Resetting Windows components fully.

```
PS C:\Users\T900> net stop wuauclt
The Windows Update service is stopping.
The Windows Update service was stopped successfully.

PS C:\Users\T900> net stop bits
The Background Intelligent Transfer Service service is not started.

More help is available by typing NET HELPMSG 3521.

PS C:\Users\T900> net stop cryptsvc
The Cryptographic Services service is stopping..
The Cryptographic Services service was stopped successfully.

PS C:\Users\T900> net stop msiserver
The Windows Installer service is not started.

More help is available by typing NET HELPMSG 3521.
```

11. Renaming the update stores

```
PS C:\Users\T900> ren C:\Windows\SoftwareDistribution SoftwareDistribution.old
PS C:\Users\T900> ren C:\Windows\System32\catroot2 catroot2.old
PS C:\Users\T900>
```

12. Restarting services

```
PS C:\Users\T900> net start wuauserv
The requested service has already been started.

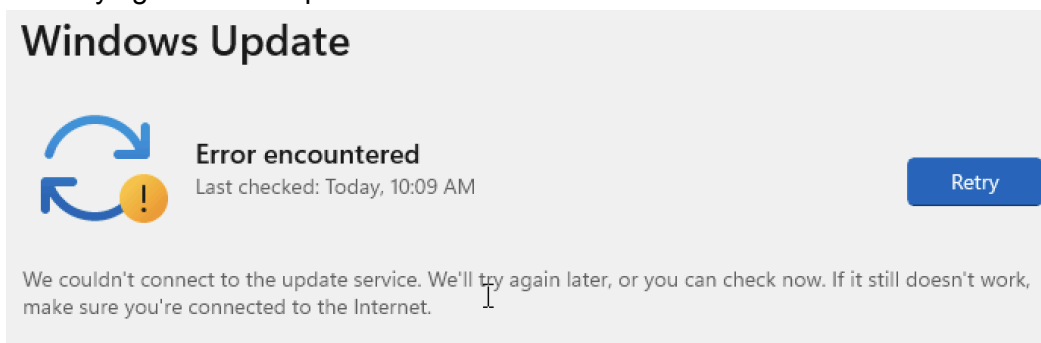
More help is available by typing NET HELPMSG 2182.

PS C:\Users\T900> net start bits
The Background Intelligent Transfer Service service is starting..
The Background Intelligent Transfer Service service was started successfully.

PS C:\Users\T900> net start cryptsvc
The Cryptographic Services service is starting.
The Cryptographic Services service was started successfully.

PS C:\Users\T900> net start msiserver
The Windows Installer service is starting.
The Windows Installer service was started successfully.
```

13. Reverting Windows Update



Analysis: Windows Update still fails.

14. Checking WinHTTP proxy.

```
PS C:\Users\T900> netsh winhttp show proxy

Current WinHTTP proxy settings:

Proxy Server(s) : 127.0.0.1:8888
Bypass List      : (none)
```

Analysis: Windows HTTP proxy settings were configured to route traffic through a local proxy (127.0.0.1:8888). This indicates Windows Update requests were being redirected to a local endpoint, likely causing connection failures when no functional proxy service was available. This misconfiguration is a probable cause of the “couldn’t connect to update service” error despite working network connectivity.

15. Resetting WinHTTP proxy.

```
PS C:\Users\T900> netsh winhttp reset proxy

Current WinHTTP proxy settings:

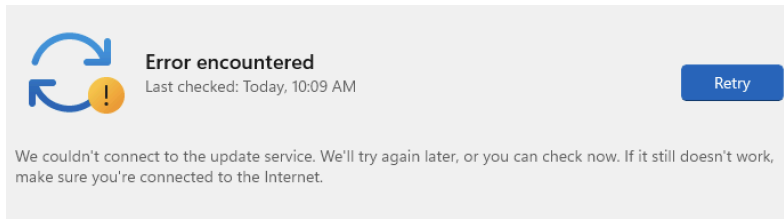
Direct access (no proxy server).

PS C:\Users\T900> netsh winhttp show proxy

Current WinHTTP proxy settings:

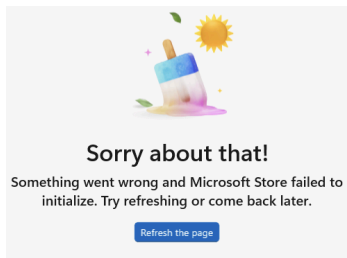
Direct access (no proxy server).
```


16. Reverifying Windows Update



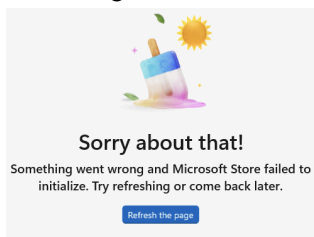
Analysis: Update failure persists after full service, network, component store (DISM/SFC), cache reset, and WinHTTP proxy remediation. Issue likely due to servicing stack corruption. Escalating to in-place repair upgrade.

17. Going into Microsoft Store to download Media Creation Tool



Analysis: Even with network connection, Microsoft Store still fails to open. There is likely a broken Windows app platform

18. Resetting Microsoft Store cache



Analysis: Microsoft Store still fails to open.

19. Reregistering Microsoft Store + AppX system packages

```
PS C:\Users\T900> Get-AppxPackage -allusers Microsoft.WindowsStore | Foreach {
>> Add-AppxPackage -DisableDevelopmentMode -Register "$($_.InstallLocation)\AppxManifest.xml"
>> }
Add-AppxPackage : Deployment failed with HRESULT: 0x80070005, Access is denied.
Deployment Register operation with target volume C: on Package
Microsoft.WindowsStore_22604.1401.6.0_neutral~Swakyb3d8bbwe from: (AppxBundleManifest.xml) failed with error
0x80070005. See http://go.microsoft.com/fwlink/?linkid=235160 for help diagnosing app deployment issues.
NOTE: For additional information, look for [ActivityId] 293d42d8-ecb7-0000-9cdb-4129b7ecdc01 in the Event Log or use
the command line Get-AppxPackageLog -ActivityID 293d42d8-ecb7-0000-9cdb-4129b7ecdc01
At line:2 char:1
+ Add-AppxPackage -DisableDevelopmentMode -Register "$($_.InstallLocati ...
+ ~~~~~
+ CategoryInfo          : SecurityError: (C:\Program File...ppxManifest.xml:String) [Add-AppxPackage], PSSecurityE
xception
+ FullyQualifiedErrorId : DeploymentError,Microsoft.Windows.Appx.PackageManager.Commands.AddAppxPackageCommand
```

Analysis: Attempted to re-register the Microsoft Store application using Add-AppxPackage. The operation failed with HRESULT 0x80070005 (Access is denied), indicating a permissions or security context failure during AppX package deployment. This suggests the Microsoft Store package cannot be re-registered due to restricted access to system package resources or underlying AppX deployment service/security policy issues, further confirming corruption or blocking within the Windows app deployment framework.

Conclusion: Windows Update and Microsoft Store failures persisted despite service validation, network verification, DISM/SFC repair, update cache reset, proxy correction, and AppX re-registration attempts. Final attempt to re-register Microsoft Store failed with access denied (0x80070005), indicating deeper system-level AppX or security-related corruption beyond standard repair scope. The issue requires a system rebuild or an in-place upgrade repair for full resolution.